Observations

Lab note for Chunk Window length ablation.

Passage length was changed while the embedding model stayed fixed.

The observations follow.

Chunks near 900 characters beat both 300-character slices and 2,000-character slices on recall at five.

Very short slices lost the sentence that actually stated the result.

The working decision is: Index narrative pages in roughly 900-character section-bounded chunks..

Measurement

How it was measured: The same 80 questions were retrieved three times, changing only the chunker length and overlap.

What came back: Recall at five was 0.61 at 300 characters, 0.78 at 900 characters, and 0.70 at 2,000 characters.

What this does not show: The ablation used English technical prose and may not transfer to slide decks with sparse text.

Still unresolved: Does the best length change when tables are stored as separate chunks? Operational risks: Severity low: A long chunk can bury a relevant sentence under unrelated paragraphs from the same section.

Recommended action: Prefer section-bounded chunks before increasing the character budget..